and a tap-room, over which are the women's apartments, five of whom were in the secret chambers, and twenty more at large. There are eighteen of these strong rooms for the men, which are close and offensive, each of them having but one window for admitting air and light. These rooms are never opened without an order from the governor of the city. There were sixty-eight prisoners. They are not permitted to go out of their rooms at any time, but for examination. Some having been confined there many years, appeared with pale sickly countenances; but none were in irons. Here is a chamber for distracted prisoners, in which were seven miserable objects. There are several chambers with beds for those who are called prisoners at large, for which each pays one paule and a half (about eightpence) a night. There is a chamber for priests, one for boys, one for Jews, and one for prisoners who have cutaneous disorders. On the upper floor are two infirmaries: one, appropriated to the prisoners in the secrete, in which were four patients. In the other, which is for the rest of the prisoners, were ten patients the first time I was there, and the last time only seven. This infirmary is a spacious airy ward, seventy-three feet by twenty-three, with seventeen beds, three feet three inches asunder; was clean, and had everything proper for the sick. The whole prison is arched with brick, for security in case of fire. The passages are seven feet two inches wide, and light. The ascent to each story, is by two flights of seventeen stone steps. These staircases are seven feet three inches wide; the rises five inches: this I mention, as generally, in our prisons (even those that are lately built) the stairs are narrow, the rises high, and the passages dark and inconvenient. There is a table of regulations by the authority of the magistrates hung up in this prison, ordering the exact times, of opening the prison and the court, of saying mass daily, and of distributing the alms. The times vary twice in a month, according to the different length of the days. In the same table, the physician is ordered to visit the sick in the infirmary every morning; and in case of extraordinary illness, in the evening. I wish I could say I had seen no torture-chamber. On the side of the great prison there is a pulley and rope to draw up malefactors by their hands which are tied behind them; after they have been suspended some time, by being suddenly let down part of the way, their arms are dislocated.

San Angelo. The State prisoners are confined in the castle of San Angelo. The rooms appropriated to that purpose were

all empty, except one, in which was a bishop, who had been confined upwards of twenty years, and was distracted. Here were also eighteen condannati who work in the fortress, and had each a light chain. They seemed healthy and well. On the death of the Pope, the prisoners are brought hither from the great prison, for upon such occasions the prisons are thoroughly cleaned.

I can give but little information respecting the prison of the inquisition. It is situated near the great church of St. Peter's. On one side of the court round which it is built, is the inquisitor-general's palace. Over the gate is an inscription importing "that it was erected by Pope Pius V in the year 1569." The windows of the prison have wooden blinds, and at a small distance is a high wall. The chambers of this silent and melancholy abode were quite inaccessible to me; and yet I spent near two hours about the court and the priests' apartments, till my continuance there began to raise suspicion.

In this city, as in most parts of Italy, is a *confraternità della misericordia,* called S. Giovanni di Fiorentini: as many of Florentine extraction were the founders. This institution is ancient, for the church of S. Gio Battista Decollato belonged to them in 1450. It consists of about seventy, chiefly nobles, of the best families. After a prisoner is condemned, one or two of them come to him the midnight before his execution, inform him of the sentence, and continue with him till his death. They, with the confessor, exhort and comfort him, and give him his choice of the most delicious food. All the fraternity attend the execution, dressed in white. When the prisoner is dead, they leave him hanging till the evening; then one of the fraternity, generally a noble, cuts him down, and orders him to be conveyed to the burying-place which they have appropriated to malefactors. I was there the twenty-ninth of August, the only day in the year when this burying-place is opened to the public. Adjoining to an elegant church is a chapel, which makes one side of a court, and on each of the other three sides, is a portico supported by Doric pillars. In the middle of the pavement [1] of the front portico the women, and in one of the side porticoes

[1] Here are marble stones, in which are circular apertures for the interment of those that are executed. Round these stones is inscribed:

"Domine, cum veneris judicare,
Noli nos condemnare."

O Lord, when thou shalt come to judge,
do not condemn us.